Guitar Exercises - Section XII, Level 89

Country, Americana, and Hybrid-Picking Groove

Alternating Bass • Boom-Chuck • Train Rhythm • Double-Stops • Bass Runs • Controlled Fills

Level 89 of the fixed 105-level core curriculum. HARD STOP after Level 105.

The focus is coordinated independence between low-string bass motion and upper-string chord or melodic responses. The groove must remain stable even when the picking hand alternates between flat pick and fingers.

Module	Exercise	Events
A	Alternating-bass independence	144
B	Boom-chuck and bass/chord balance	144
C	Train rhythm and muted subdivision	144
D	Hybrid-picking attack balance	128
E	Double-stops and sixths as rhythmic answers	128
F	Bass-run approaches and controlled fills	128
G	Country/Americana pocket variations	160
H	Four eight-bar groove studies	192
I	Thirty-two-bar country/Americana capstone	256
J	Recovery and pocket audit	64
	TOTAL	1488

Core rule: bass establishes the ground; upper voices answer without disturbing it.

Reference - Right-Hand Roles

Symbol	Right hand	Typical job
P	flat pick	bass notes, low-string accents, strums
m	middle finger	upper-string note or dyad
a	ring finger	second upper voice / double-stop
x	muted/dead contact	train-rhythm percussion
-	air stroke / silence	keeps the grid while leaving space

Hybrid-picking hierarchy: the pick must not overpower the fingers. Start with open strings until P, m, and a can produce comparable volume.

Module A - Alternating Bass Independence

Play each bass pattern alone before adding any chord.

Chord	Bass pattern	Count
G	G-D-G-D	1-2-3-4
C	C-G-C-G	1-2-3-4
D	D-A-D-A	1-2-3-4
A	A-E-A-E	1-2-3-4
E	E-B-E-B	1-2-3-4
Am	A-E-A-E	1-2-3-4
Em	E-B-E-B	1-2-3-4
F	F-C-F-C	1-2-3-4

Passes: bass only -> bass while silently fretting chord -> bass + upper chord on beats 2/4 -> bass + upper melodic note.

Module A - Alternating Bass with Chord Answers

Pattern	Beat 1	Beat 2	Beat 3	Beat 4
1	bass root	upper chord	bass fifth	upper chord
2	bass root	high dyad	bass fifth	high dyad
3	bass root	rest	bass fifth	chord
4	bass root	chord	bass approach	next-chord pickup
5	bass root	upper melody	bass fifth	upper melody
6	bass root	m+a double-stop	bass fifth	P strum

The low note must arrive with the same timing and weight even when the upper response changes.

Module B - Boom-Chuck Balance

Boom = bass note. Chuck = short upper chord. The chord should sound like a response, not a second bass hit.

Cell	Pattern	Goal
1	Boom Chuck Boom Chuck	basic quarter-note pocket
2	Boom - Chuck - Boom - Chuck -	eighth-grid separation
3	Boom Chuck x Chuck	add muted backbeat
4	Boom Chuck Boom Chuck&	late pickup into next bar
5	Boom high-chuck Boom low-chuck	register contrast
6	Boom Chuck Boom rest	leave beat 4 for bass fill

Use G-C-D-G and A-D-E-A. Keep the chuck above the D string whenever possible so the low bass remains distinct.

Module C - Train Rhythm

Train rhythm uses a continuous muted subdivision with selected accented bass/chord contacts. Keep the hand moving through rests.

Cell	Grid	Accent map
1	P x P x P x P x	quarter-note drive
2	P x x P x P x x	3+3+2 feel
3	P x P x x P x P	displaced accents
4	P x x x P x x x	one strong contact per beat
5	P x P x P P x P	pickup-oriented
6	P x x P P x x P	alternating density

First use muted low strings. Then replace selected P attacks with bass roots or power-chord fragments.

Module C - Train-Rhythm Chord Integration

Progression	Bass landmark	Chord response
G-C-D-G	roots on beat 1	upper chord on 2/4
A-D-E-A	root/fifth alternation	short chord on &2/&4
E-A-B7-E	low-E pedal	B7 stab before resolution
C-F-G-C	walking bass into IV/V	chord waits until destination
Am-G-F-E7	descending bass	upper triad remains clipped
D-G-A-D	bass fill beat 4	guitar rests during fill

The muted train pulse is a background layer. Do not let dead contacts become louder than bass or chord landmarks.

Module D - Hybrid-Picking Attack Balance

Cell	String order	Right hand
1	low E - G - B	P-m-a
2	A - G - e	P-m-a
3	D - B - e	P-m-a
4	bass - high dyad	P-(m+a)
5	bass - middle - high - middle	P-m-a-m
6	bass - high - bass - middle	P-a-P-m
7	bass + upper dyad simultaneous	P+(m+a)
8	pick strum then finger answer	P - m+a

Play open strings first. Then use G, C, D, A, and E triads. Equalize tone and volume before increasing tempo.

Module E - Double-Stops and Sixths

Key	Double-stop route	Function
G	B3/e3 -> B5/e5 -> B7/e7	3rds/6ths color around I
C	G5/B5 -> G7/B6 -> G9/B8	upper harmony movement
D	B7/e5 -> B8/e7 -> B10/e9	diatonic answer
A	G6/B5 -> G7/B7 -> G9/B10	country-style upper pair
E	G4/B5 -> G6/B7 -> G8/B9	upper-register response
Am	G5/B5 -> G7/B6 -> G9/B8	minor-color answer

Use these as short answers after boom-chuck patterns. Do not allow the answer to cover the next bass root.

Module E - Rhythmic Double-Stop Answers

Cell	Question	Answer placement
1	boom-chuck	double-stop on &4
2	two beats bass/chord	double-stop on beat 4
3	train rhythm	two-note answer on a3-&4
4	held chord	double-stop pickup into next bar
5	bass walk	answer after destination root
6	rested beat 4	double-stop only if bass is silent

Start with one two-note answer. Add slides or hammer-ons only after the rhythmic opening remains clear.

Module F - Bass-Run Approaches

Destination	Bass run	Rule
C	G-A-B-C	land C on beat 1
G	D-E-F#-G	land G on beat 1
D	A-B-C#-D	land D on beat 1
A	E-F#-G#-A	land A on beat 1
E	B-C#-D#-E	land E on beat 1
Am	E-F-G-G#-A	chromatic leading tone before A
Em	B-C-C#-D#-E	chromatic approach, simplify if rushed

The run is subordinate to the destination. If the root is late, shorten the run rather than speeding up.

Module F - Controlled Fill Windows

Window	Maximum fill	Return point
beat 4	2 eighth notes	next beat 1
&3 to 4&	3 eighth notes	next beat 1
beat 3-4	4 eighth notes	next beat 1
half bar	one 4-note double-stop/bass fill	next measure
full bar	one 6-8 note phrase	next section landmark
no window	rest	do not force a fill

A fill that causes a late boom, chuck, or next-chord root fails even if the notes are correct.

Module G - Country/Americana Pocket Variations

Pocket	Harmony	Primary behavior
Boom-chuck	G-C-D-G	alternating root/fifth bass, short upper chord
Train rhythm	E-A-B7-E	muted subdivision with low-string accents
Hybrid two-step	A-D-E-A	P bass, m+a upper dyad
Americana ballad	C-G-Am-F	longer chord answers, sparse bass walk
Country shuffle	D-G-A-D	shuffle bass, clipped chord response
Double-stop pocket	G-C-G-D	boom-chuck + two-note pickup
Bass-run pocket	C-Am-F-G	walk into each destination root
Sparse acoustic	G-D-Em-C	one bass, one chord, one fill max per bar

Run all eight at one tempo first. Then choose tempos appropriate to each feel while preserving the internal balance rules.

Module G - Same Progression, Four Arrangements

Use | G | C | D | G | for all four.

Version	Bass	Upper guitar	Fill
1	root/fifth quarters	boom-chuck	none
2	alternating bass eighths	hybrid dyads	one double-stop at bar 4
3	train rhythm	short chord accents	bass run into D
4	walking bass	sustained upper triads	one 2-note answer

The progression does not define the style. The orchestration does.

Module H - Study 1 - Boom-chuck two-step

| G | C | D | G | G | C | D | G |

Alternating bass on 1/3; clipped upper chord on 2/4.

Pass	Requirement
1	bass only
2	upper chord/double-stop only
3	combine bass + chord
4	add one fill window
5	hybrid-picking balance audit
6	record with click only on 2 and 4

Module H - Study 2 - Train-rhythm drive

| E | A | B7 | E | E | A | B7 | E |

Muted continuous subdivision; low-string accents; chord punctuation.

Pass	Requirement
1	bass only
2	upper chord/double-stop only
3	combine bass + chord
4	add one fill window
5	hybrid-picking balance audit
6	record with click only on 2 and 4

Module H - Study 3 - Hybrid-picking ballad

| C | G/B | Am | F | C/E | Dm | G | C |

P bass plus m/a upper voices; bass inversions stay smooth.

Pass	Requirement
1	bass only
2	upper chord/double-stop only
3	combine bass + chord
4	add one fill window
5	hybrid-picking balance audit
6	record with click only on 2 and 4

Module H - Study 4 - Fill-and-return

| G | Em | C | D | G | C | D | G |

One short double-stop or bass run per two bars; never cover next root.

Pass	Requirement
1	bass only
2	upper chord/double-stop only
3	combine bass + chord
4	add one fill window
5	hybrid-picking balance audit
6	record with click only on 2 and 4

Module I - Thirty-Two-Bar Country/Americana Capstone

Bars	Harmony	Groove	Primary engine	Dynamic
1-4	G-C-D-G	boom-chuck	root/fifth bass	mp
5-8	E-A-B7-E	train rhythm	muted subdivision	mf
9-12	A-D-E-A	hybrid two-step	P + m/a	mf
13-16	C-G/B-Am-F	Americana ballad	walking bass	mp
17-20	D-G-A-D	country shuffle	shuffle bass/chuck	mf
21-24	G-C-G-D	double-stop pocket	boom-chuck + answers	f
25-28	C-Am-F-G	bass-run pocket	approach roots	mf
29-32	G-D-Em-C	sparse acoustic outro	reduction + final fill	mf -> p

One master tempo for the first five passes. Announce each new groove on beat 4 of the prior section. Do not insert a reset bar.

Module J - Recovery, Mastery, and Roadmap

Failure	Immediate repair
Bass loses pulse	roots only on quarter notes
Chuck too loud/low	move chord to upper strings; reduce pick depth
Hybrid fingers too weak	open-string P/m/a balance drill
Train rhythm rushes	mute all strings; foot quarters
Double-stop overlaps root	end answer one eighth earlier
Bass run arrives late	delete first approach note
Fill becomes too long	return to one 2-note answer
Form lost	boom-chuck roots until next 4-bar boundary

Mastery: 14/16 or better on two separate days across pulse, alternating bass, boom-chuck balance, train rhythm, hybrid-picking balance, fill discipline, groove contrast, and recovery. No zero in pulse, alternating bass, fill discipline, or recovery.

Next: Level 90 completes Section XII with jazz swing, shuffle, Afrobeat/Latin-influenced interlock, jam-band pocket, and multi-style groove synthesis.

Fixed roadmap: 85-90 Groove & Stylistic Rhythm; 91-94 Advanced Expression; 95-99 Repertoire Integration; 100-104 Composition; 105 Final Musicianship Capstone. HARD STOP after 105.